NODERAG

Quick Start Guide

Install on Synology, complete first-time setup, ingest documents, search them, and save useful passages into a research space.

1	**Install the Synology package**
2	**Copy and use the one-time setup key**
3	**Add documents and run a search**
4	**Create a research space and save passages**

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PART 1

Install NodeRag and copy the setup key

Use these steps for a first installation on a supported Synology NAS.

Before you start — You need DSM 7.2 or later on an x86_64 Synology, plus the Synology packages Node.js_v22 and WebStation. Keep the NodeRag SPK file on the computer you use to open DSM.

1 Open Package Center

Sign in to DSM as an administrator. Open Package Center, then choose Manual Install.

2 Choose the NodeRag package

Select noderag-1.0.0-21-x86_64.spk. Accept the package information and continue through the installer.

3 Copy the complete setup key

On the page named NodeRag setup key, double-click inside the One-time setup key field, then press Ctrl+C. Paste it into a temporary protected note so you do not lose it.

A valid key starts with setup_ and continues with 64 letters and numbers. Do not add spaces.

4 Finish the installation

Select Run after installation, then choose Done. Wait until Package Center shows NodeRag as Running.

5 Open the website

Open http://<NAS-IP>/noderag/ in a browser. Replace <NAS-IP> with your Synology address, for example http://10.240.0.241/noderag/.

Key safety — The setup key expires 24 hours after NodeRag first starts. It is removed after setup is complete. Treat it like a password until setup is finished.

PART 2

Use the key to set up NodeRag

The setup page remembers your progress, so you can safely return if a download or calibration takes time.

1

Confirm this installation

Paste the complete key into Setup key, then choose Verify and continue.

2

Create the administrator

Enter a username, optional email, a name for your first knowledge space, and a password of at least 12 characters. Choose Create administrator.

3

Save the recovery code

Choose Copy full recovery code and store the code in a password manager or another protected place. Then choose I saved it - continue to sign in.

4

Choose document storage

Use the default private storage unless you need a Synology shared folder. If you use a shared folder, give the NodeRag package account read and write access at the shared-folder level. Choose Test and save storage.

5

Install the embedding model

Choose Install model and continue. The recommended Qwen3 model is about 584 MB and is verified after download.

6

Measure this machine

Choose Run calibration. NodeRag measures 20 sample chunks. When the result appears, choose Continue.

7

Optional image understanding

Enter the Ollama address, model, and API key, then choose Test connection. You may choose Skip for now and configure vision later.

8

Optional source folder

Add a folder that NodeRag can read, or choose Skip for now. When setup is complete, choose Open NodeRag.

If the key is rejected	Check that you copied every character. If the key is missing or expired, restart the NodeRag package to issue a new key, then use the newly displayed key.

PART 3

Ingest documents

NodeRag accepts PDF, Word, Excel, Markdown, and text files. Choose the method that matches how you store your documents.

METHOD A - UPLOAD ONE FILE

1

Open Ingest

Use the left menu and select Ingest. In the Upload a file box, choose the destination knowledge space.

2

Choose the file

Select Choose file, pick a supported document, then choose Add to queue.

3

Watch document processing

The document row moves through 1/3 Markdown, 2/3 chunking, and 3/3 embedding. It is ready to search when processing finishes.

METHOD B - CONNECT A FOLDER

1

Select the source folder

In Connect an input folder, choose a knowledge space. Enter the absolute Synology path or choose Browse. The folder is read-only to NodeRag; source files are not changed.

2

Choose what to include

Keep the supplied file patterns or edit them. Leave Repeat every (minutes) empty for manual use, or enter a schedule.

3

Verify and connect

Choose Verify and connect. The NodeRag package account must have read permission on the Synology shared folder.

4

Start the crawl

Under Connected input folders, choose Crawl now. Scheduled folders will also crawl automatically.

Need to change a folder?

Use Edit schedule and patterns to change the schedule, or Disconnect folder to remove the connection. Disconnecting does not delete the source files.

PART 4

Search documents

Search returns source passages with confidence values and links back to the original PDF or rendered Markdown.

1

Open Search

Select Search in the left menu. Choose the knowledge space you want to search.

2

Choose a search mode

Use Both for the best general result. Meaning finds related ideas, Semantic is more focused on matching phrases and sentences, and Keyword looks for exact terms.

3

Set confidence

Start with a confidence cutoff of 0.30. Lower it to see more results; raise it to keep only stronger matches.

4

Run the search

Type a question or phrase and submit it. Results are grouped by document. Open a result to view the cited PDF page or the formatted Markdown source.

5

Move through results

In a document viewer, use Up/Down for the previous or next search result. Use Left/Right to move within the PDF or Markdown document.

OK	A document must finish all three ingestion stages before it can appear in search.
OK	If no results appear, try Both mode and lower confidence slightly.
OK	For a PDF, yellow highlights show exact terms and green highlights show semantic matches.

Privacy reminder	A local embedding model keeps document search on the NAS. If optional Ollama Cloud vision is enabled, images sent for analysis leave the local network.

PART 5

Create and use a research space

A research space is a personal collection of useful source passages. It can hold references from more than one knowledge space.

1

Create the research space

Select Research in the left menu. Under Create research, enter a clear name such as Legal Notes, then choose Create research.

2

Choose it before searching

Return to Search. At the top, open Save passages to research and select Legal Notes.

3

Find a useful passage

Run a search and open a result. Review the cited page or formatted source.

4

Save the passage

Press the 0 key while viewing the passage, or choose the save button. The result will show that it is saved in Legal Notes. If no research space is selected, NodeRag asks you to select one.

5

Review saved passages

Open Research, then choose Legal Notes under Open research. Select any saved item to reopen its source.

6

Navigate or remove

Use Up/Down for the previous or next saved passage and Left/Right inside the document. Press 0 or choose Remove to remove a saved reference; confirm when asked.

What research saves	Research stores a reference to the source passage. It does not copy or delete the original document, and it never gives a user access to a knowledge space they cannot already open.

QUICK HELP

If something does not work

Start with the matching item below. These checks cover the most common first-install and first-ingestion problems.

OK	Setup key rejected: copy the complete setup_ value; restart NodeRag if it expired.
OK	Storage or folder rejected: grant the NodeRag package account permission on the Synology shared folder, not only a lower subfolder.
OK	Ingestion stopped: open Administration, then Logs, and review the rolling 24-hour ingestion log.
OK	Search is empty: confirm ingestion finished, then try Both mode at 0.30 confidence.

Website will not open	Confirm Package Center shows NodeRag as Running. Then open http://<NAS-IP>/noderag/. Include the final slash. If you use a public hostname, its WebStation or reverse-proxy rule must also point to the NodeRag alias.

Large files take time	A large PDF may spend several minutes in a single stage. Check the document row for a recent progress update. Use Administration > Logs if the row stops or reports that all retry attempts failed.

Success checklist

OK	NodeRag opens and you can sign in with the administrator account.
OK	At least one document finishes Markdown, chunking, and embedding.
OK	Search opens a cited passage from that document.
OK	The passage can be saved to a named research space.

You are ready when all four checks above are complete.